



BEN and NAOMI:  
WHAT *They*  
DIDN'T KNOW

**B**en and Naomi were both from middle-income families. They grew up in the suburban area of Chicago and did their share of chores around the house.

Naomi's father was a practical person who kept the household records and distributed the money. He budgeted an amount for Naomi's mother to manage the household. He paid all the other bills and gave Naomi a modest allowance. Naomi was required to work for a portion of her clothing and entertainment money.

In Ben's family the distribution of tasks was different. His mother handled the checkbook and paid the bills. His father never got involved with family finances, except when he wanted to buy something. Then he simply wrote a check for the amount he needed. That habit caused some terrible fights, since he never bothered to record his check amounts. Ben could almost always go to his dad and get money when he needed it. When he did this, Ben's father usually told him not to tell his mother, because she would have a fit. Ben's father worked hard on his job, even picking up overtime